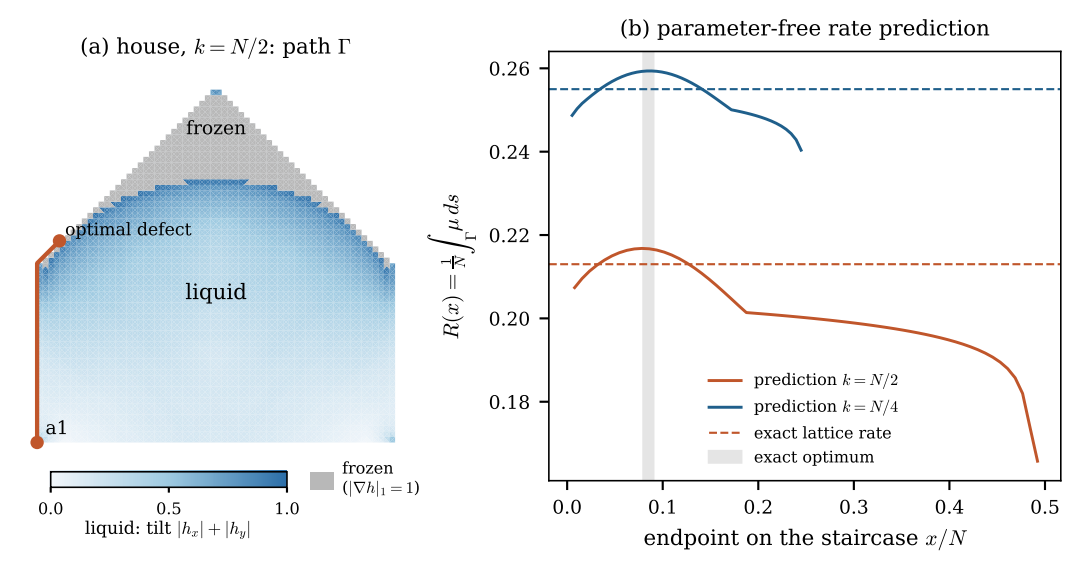

(a) house, $k = N/2$: path $\Gamma$
frozen
optimal defect
liquid
a1
0.0
0.5
1.0
liquid: tilt $|h_x| + |h_y|$
frozen
$(|\nabla h|_1 = 1)$
(b) parameter-free rate prediction
$R(x) = \frac{1}{N}\int_\Gamma \mu\, ds$
0.26
0.24
0.22
0.20
0.18
prediction $k = N/2$
prediction $k = N/4$
exact lattice rate
exact optimum
0.0
0.1
0.2
0.3
0.4
0.5
endpoint on the staircase $x/N$